



# HealthDecoded Handbook

**Building Health Literacy Through  
Student Leadership**

# **Understanding the HealthDecoded Mission**

HealthDecoded was founded on the belief that students should be equipped with the knowledge and skills needed to navigate healthcare confidently long before they are required to make important health-related decisions on their own. While traditional education covers many academic subjects, topics such as healthcare navigation, preventive care, medication literacy, and evaluating health information are often overlooked. HealthDecoded works to fill this gap by providing practical, student-centered health education that empowers young people to make informed decisions about their health and well-being. A major focus of HealthDecoded is healthcare navigation. Many students are unfamiliar with concepts such as primary care providers, specialists, referrals, urgent care centers, and health insurance. Through presentations and educational resources, HealthDecoded helps students better understand how the healthcare system functions and how to access appropriate care when needed. By developing these skills early, students can feel more confident interacting with healthcare professionals and advocating for their own health needs. The organization also emphasizes preventive care and medication literacy. Students learn about the importance of healthy habits, routine checkups, vaccinations, and understanding prescription medications. These topics encourage individuals to take an active role in maintaining their health rather than only seeking care when problems arise. In addition, HealthDecoded promotes digital health literacy by teaching students how to evaluate health information found online and distinguish credible sources from misinformation. Another important component of the mission is health equity. HealthDecoded encourages students to recognize that access to healthcare and health outcomes can be influenced by social, economic, and environmental factors. By fostering awareness of these issues, the organization promotes empathy, understanding, and informed discussions about healthcare access. Ultimately, HealthDecoded's mission is to create a generation of health-literate individuals who are prepared to navigate healthcare systems, make informed decisions, and contribute to healthier communities. Through education, outreach, and engagement, the organization seeks to make health knowledge more accessible, practical, and empowering for all students.



# **Section 1: Chapter**

# **Information/Requirements**

# Understanding HealthDecoded Chapters

HealthDecoded was founded on the belief that every student deserves access to practical health education. While traditional education prepares students for careers, higher education, and civic engagement, many young people receive little instruction on how to navigate healthcare systems, understand medical information, communicate with healthcare professionals, or make informed decisions about their health. HealthDecoded exists to help close this gap by providing accessible, student-centered health literacy education.

As the organization expands, local chapters serve as the foundation of HealthDecoded's impact. Chapters allow students to bring health literacy education directly into their schools and communities through workshops, educational events, outreach initiatives, partnerships, and advocacy efforts. Every chapter operates as part of a larger national movement dedicated to making healthcare knowledge more accessible and understandable for all students.

Being a HealthDecoded chapter involves more than simply hosting meetings or events. Chapters are responsible for fostering an environment where students can learn about healthcare, develop leadership skills, engage with their communities, and contribute to meaningful educational initiatives. Through chapter involvement, students gain valuable experience in communication, teamwork, public speaking, project management, community outreach, and leadership while helping others better understand important health-related topics.

The purpose of this handbook is to provide guidance for chapter leaders and members while establishing standards that support consistency, professionalism, and organizational growth across all HealthDecoded chapters.

## Chapter Recognition and Affiliation

Becoming an officially recognized HealthDecoded chapter is an important step in joining the organization's national network. Recognition demonstrates that a chapter has established the leadership structure, membership base, and commitment necessary to support HealthDecoded's mission and values.

Recognized chapters are considered official representatives of HealthDecoded and are authorized to operate under the organization's name. Recognition provides access to organizational resources, educational materials, leadership support, national initiatives, and opportunities for collaboration with other chapters.

To obtain recognition, prospective chapters must complete an application process established by the national organization. This process helps ensure that all chapters are adequately prepared to operate effectively and provide meaningful educational experiences within their communities.

### Requirements for Recognition

To become an officially recognized HealthDecoded chapter, applicants must:

- Submit a completed chapter application.
- Participate in an interview with HealthDecoded National Leadership.
- Submit a current membership roster.
- Establish an Executive Board.
- Secure an advisor.
- Demonstrate a commitment to HealthDecoded's mission and values.

## **Advisor Requirements**

Every chapter must maintain an advisor who provides mentorship, guidance, and institutional support.

Advisors may include:

- Teachers
- Professors
- School administrators
- Healthcare professionals
- Community leaders
- Other responsible adults over the age of 18

Advisors play an important role in supporting chapter success, but HealthDecoded chapters are intended to remain student-led organizations. Students should take primary responsibility for planning events, managing chapter operations, and advancing organizational goals.

## **Benefits of Recognition**

Officially recognized chapters may:

- Use the HealthDecoded name and branding.
- Access educational resources and organizational materials.
- Participate in national initiatives and campaigns.
- Receive support from HealthDecoded National Leadership.
- Collaborate with other recognized chapters.
- Participate in organizational awards and recognition programs.

Recognition also demonstrates credibility when communicating with schools, community organizations, and potential partners.

# **Chapter Identity and Branding**

Maintaining a consistent identity helps strengthen HealthDecoded's presence and reputation across all communities served by the organization.

To promote consistency, all chapters must follow the official chapter naming convention:

**HealthDecoded × [School Name]**

Examples include:

- HealthDecoded × Rutgers University

This naming format allows each chapter to maintain a connection to both its institution and the broader HealthDecoded organization.

Recognized chapters may use the official HealthDecoded logo provided by the national organization. School logos may also be used when permitted by institutional policies. Any modifications to official branding should be approved by HealthDecoded National Leadership before use.

Branding extends beyond logos. Social media pages, event flyers, presentations, email communications, and promotional materials should all reflect HealthDecoded's commitment to professionalism, education, accessibility, and inclusion.

Consistent branding helps students, educators, community members, and partners recognize HealthDecoded programs and strengthens trust in the organization's educational initiatives.

## Executive Board Leadership

Effective leadership is essential to the success of every HealthDecoded chapter. The Executive Board serves as the chapter's leadership team and is responsible for overseeing chapter operations, coordinating educational programming, supporting members, and ensuring that all activities align with the organization's mission.

Leadership positions should be viewed as opportunities for service and responsibility rather than titles alone. Executive Board members are expected to lead by example, maintain professionalism, support fellow members, and contribute positively to the growth of the chapter.

Every recognized chapter must maintain, at minimum, the following leadership positions.

### President

The President serves as the chief student leader and primary representative of the chapter.

The President is responsible for guiding chapter activities, leading meetings, communicating with national leadership, ensuring organizational compliance, and overseeing long-term chapter goals. The President also serves as the primary point of contact between the chapter and HealthDecoded National Leadership.

Successful Presidents demonstrate initiative, organization, accountability, and a strong commitment to HealthDecoded's mission.

## **Vice President**

The Vice President supports the President and helps coordinate chapter operations.

Responsibilities may include overseeing projects, coordinating committees, supporting member engagement, monitoring progress toward organizational goals, and assisting with event planning.

The Vice President assumes presidential responsibilities when necessary and helps ensure continuity within chapter leadership.

## **Secretary**

The Secretary is responsible for maintaining chapter records and supporting organizational communication.

Responsibilities include:

- Recording meeting minutes.
- Tracking attendance.
- Maintaining membership records.
- Organizing chapter documents.
- Distributing announcements and updates.
- Maintaining chapter calendars.

Strong organization and attention to detail are important qualities for this role.

## **Treasurer**

The Treasurer oversees chapter finances and fundraising efforts.

Responsibilities include:

- Maintaining financial records.
- Tracking expenses and revenue.
- Assisting with fundraising initiatives.
- Preparing financial reports.
- Supporting financial transparency and accountability.

The Treasurer plays an important role in ensuring that chapter resources are used responsibly and effectively.

## Publicist

The Publicist oversees chapter marketing, communications, and outreach.

Responsibilities include:

- Managing social media platforms.
- Promoting events and initiatives.
- Creating flyers and promotional materials.
- Supporting recruitment efforts.
- Increasing awareness of HealthDecoded's mission.

Strong communication and creativity are valuable assets in this position.

## Additional Leadership Positions

As chapters grow, they may choose to create additional leadership positions to meet their needs. Examples include Outreach Coordinators, Volunteer Coordinators, Workshop Directors, Fundraising Chairs, or Community Engagement Officers.

Additional positions should support the chapter's mission and organizational goals while maintaining a clear leadership structure.

## Leadership Elections and Transitions

Leadership transitions are an important part of maintaining healthy and sustainable chapters. Elections should be conducted in a transparent, fair, and democratic manner that allows members to participate in selecting future leaders. They must occur on an annual basis (Transitions must take place at the end of every school year)

Candidates for leadership positions should demonstrate consistent involvement, professionalism, reliability, and commitment to HealthDecoded's mission.

Leadership positions must be held by currently enrolled students who maintain an active presence at their institution.

Following elections, the outgoing President must notify the Chief Operating Officer of leadership changes and provide updated contact information for incoming officers.

Outgoing officers are expected to support a smooth transition by transferring records, documents, passwords, event materials, financial information, and other resources needed for continued chapter operations.

Effective transitions help preserve institutional knowledge and support long-term chapter success.



# Membership and Active Participation

HealthDecoded welcomes students from all backgrounds who share an interest in health education, community engagement, and service.

Membership is open to all eligible students without discrimination. No prior healthcare experience or academic background is required.

Students interested in joining a chapter must complete the organization's membership form and provide any information required for participation and recordkeeping purposes.

Members are expected to actively contribute to chapter activities and support the organization's mission through meaningful engagement.

Active participation helps ensure that chapters remain vibrant, productive, and capable of delivering high-quality educational programming to their communities.

## Member Responsibilities and Expectations

HealthDecoded chapters rely on the active participation and commitment of their members. While leadership teams coordinate chapter operations and organize programming, the success of a chapter ultimately depends on the engagement, reliability, and enthusiasm of its members.

Membership in HealthDecoded provides students with opportunities to contribute to meaningful educational initiatives, develop leadership skills, and participate in community service activities. In return, members are expected to actively support the chapter's mission and contribute positively to the organization's culture and goals.

One of the most important responsibilities of members is participation. Members are encouraged to attend meetings regularly, contribute ideas, volunteer for events, and support chapter initiatives whenever possible. Consistent participation helps chapters maintain momentum and ensures that educational programs can be delivered effectively.

Members should also demonstrate professionalism in their interactions with fellow students, chapter leaders, educators, community partners, and members of the public. Respectful communication, cooperation, and accountability contribute to a positive chapter environment and support HealthDecoded's reputation within the community.

In addition to attending meetings, members are encouraged to participate in workshops, outreach events, fundraising activities, and educational programs organized by the chapter. Every member contributes differently based on their interests, schedules, and strengths, but all members should strive to remain actively engaged throughout the academic year.

Members who commit to responsibilities such as event planning, volunteer support, research projects, educational initiatives, or fundraising activities are expected to complete those responsibilities to the best of their ability. Reliability and follow-through are essential components of effective teamwork.

Ultimately, membership in HealthDecoded represents a commitment to advancing health literacy while supporting fellow students and contributing to positive community impact.

## **Required Forms and Agreements for Chapter Members**

To keep each HealthDecoded chapter organized, professional, and aligned with our mission, all chapter members should complete the required membership forms before officially participating in chapter activities. These forms help chapter leadership maintain an accurate roster, set clear expectations, and make sure all members understand HealthDecoded's role as a health literacy organization.

### **Required for All Members:**

All members should complete the following:

#### **1. Member Registration Form**

This form collects basic information for the chapter roster, including name, school, email, phone number, year/grade, areas of interest, availability, and preferred level of involvement. This helps chapter leaders communicate with members and organize events more effectively.

#### **2. Member Agreement and Code of Conduct**

All members must agree to represent HealthDecoded respectfully and professionally. Members are expected to be inclusive, reliable, respectful toward peers and community members, and mindful that they are representing both their local chapter and the broader HealthDecoded organization.

Members must also agree that HealthDecoded provides health literacy education only and does not provide medical diagnosis, treatment, or individualized medical advice. Members should not present themselves as medical professionals or give personal medical recommendations.

#### **3. Health Information Disclaimer Agreement**

Because HealthDecoded works with health-related topics, members must understand that all educational content should be based on credible sources and reviewed by chapter leadership before being shared

publicly. Members should avoid spreading misinformation, making unsupported claims, or offering individualized advice.

If someone asks for personal medical guidance, members should direct them to a licensed healthcare professional, school health office, emergency services, or another appropriate resource.

#### 4. Media Release Form

Members should complete a media release form indicating whether they consent to being photographed, filmed, or featured in HealthDecoded materials, including social media posts, flyers, newsletters, the website, presentations, or promotional content. Members should be able to opt out of media use if they prefer.

### Required for Chapter Leaders

Chapter board members or leadership team members should also complete a Chapter Leadership Agreement. This agreement should outline expectations for communication, meeting attendance, event planning, record keeping, responsible use of the HealthDecoded name, and communication with school administrators, advisors, community partners, or outside organizations.

Chapter leaders are expected to maintain professionalism, follow HealthDecoded guidelines, and receive approval from the main HealthDecoded team before making major partnerships, public statements, fundraising plans, or external commitments on behalf of the organization.

### Event-Specific Forms:

For larger events, off-campus activities, community outreach, fundraisers, panels, or volunteer opportunities, chapters may also require an Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver. This form should include the event name, date, role expectations, emergency contact information, and acknowledgment of any basic responsibilities or risks connected to the event.

### Summary of Recommended Forms:

At minimum, every chapter should collect:

- Member Registration Form
- Member Agreement and Code of Conduct
- Health Information Disclaimer Agreement
- Media Release Form

### Chapter leaders should also complete:

- Chapter Leadership Agreement

For larger or off-campus events, chapters may also use:

- Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver

These forms help protect the chapter, keep communication organized, and make sure every member understands the mission and expectations of HealthDecoded.

## **Chapter Point System and Recognition**

To encourage participation and recognize member contributions, each chapter should establish a point system at the beginning of every academic year.

Point systems provide a structured way to track engagement while encouraging members to participate in a variety of organizational activities. Chapters have flexibility to adapt their systems based on local needs, but all point systems should be clearly communicated to members and shared with the national organization.

Suggested point values include:

### **Meeting Attendance**

Regular chapter meetings provide opportunities for planning, discussion, and organizational updates.

Recommended Value:

- 2 points per meeting attended

### **Educational Workshops**

Workshops represent one of HealthDecoded's primary educational activities and often require active participation from members.

Recommended Value:

- 5 points per workshop attended or supported

### **Community Events**

Community outreach activities help expand HealthDecoded's impact beyond the chapter itself.

Recommended Value:

- 5–10 points per event

## **Fundraising Participation**

Fundraising helps support chapter programming and educational initiatives.

Recommended Value:

- 2 or more points based on level of involvement

## **Volunteer Service**

Volunteer activities represent direct contributions to the organization's mission.

Recommended Value:

- 5 points per volunteer activity

Chapters may establish additional point categories for leadership roles, committee participation, recruitment efforts, content creation, or other activities that support chapter goals.

At the beginning of each academic year, chapters should establish a minimum point requirement for active membership. This requirement should be communicated clearly to all members.

**National leadership may recognize chapters and individuals who demonstrate exceptional participation, growth, community impact, and organizational engagement.**

# **Fundraising and Financial Accountability**

Fundraising plays an important role in supporting chapter operations and expanding HealthDecoded's impact within local communities.

Funds raised by chapters may be used to support educational programming, workshop materials, community outreach initiatives, event expenses, promotional materials, and other activities that advance HealthDecoded's mission.

All fundraising activities should reflect the organization's values and maintain high standards of professionalism and ethical conduct.

Examples of appropriate fundraising activities may include:

- Educational fundraisers
- Restaurant partnerships
- School-sponsored fundraising events
- Community awareness campaigns
- Merchandise sales approved by chapter leadership
- Donation drives

Fundraising activities must comply with:

- School or university policies
- Local laws and regulations
- HealthDecoded standards and expectations

Activities involving illegal behavior, inappropriate content, substance abuse promotion, or conduct inconsistent with the organization's mission are prohibited.

Financial accountability is equally important.

Chapters should maintain accurate records of:

- Revenue received
- Expenses incurred
- Fundraising outcomes
- Budget allocations

Financial records should be organized and available for review by chapter leadership and the national organization when requested.

Transparency helps build trust and ensures that resources are used responsibly in support of educational programming and community impact.

Misuse of funds may result in disciplinary action, suspension, or loss of chapter recognition.

## **Social Media and Public Communications**

Social media provides HealthDecoded chapters with valuable opportunities to educate, recruit, engage, and connect with their communities.

Every recognized chapter is encouraged to maintain an active online presence that reflects the organization's mission and values.

Chapter social media accounts should clearly identify themselves as official HealthDecoded chapters and include national instagram in the bio.

Content shared through chapter accounts should support one or more of the following goals:

- Promoting health literacy
- Advertising events and workshops
- Celebrating chapter achievements
- Recruiting members
- Sharing educational resources
- Highlighting community impact

All content should remain professional, respectful, and appropriate for public audiences.

Members should avoid posting:

- Offensive content
- Discriminatory language
- Medical misinformation
- Inappropriate images
- Confidential information
- Content posted without permission

Photos and videos of participants should only be shared when appropriate permission has been obtained.

Comments and online interactions should be monitored to ensure respectful engagement.

Social media represents an extension of the organization's public image and should be managed thoughtfully and responsibly.

## **Meetings, Workshops, and Educational Programming**

Educational programming is central to HealthDecoded's mission.

Through meetings, workshops, presentations, and community events, chapters help increase awareness and understanding of important healthcare topics.

### **Chapter Meetings**

Every chapter is required to conduct at least one meeting each month.

Regular meetings allow members to:

- Discuss chapter initiatives
- Plan upcoming events
- Share updates
- Coordinate projects
- Build chapter community

Meeting agendas should be prepared in advance whenever possible.

Attendance should be recorded and maintained as part of chapter records.

Meeting minutes should also be documented and archived for future reference.

## **Workshops**

Each chapter must organize at least two educational workshops each academic year.

Workshop topics may include:

- Healthcare navigation
- Preventive care
- Medication literacy
- Digital health literacy
- Health equity
- Other health-related educational topics

Workshops should prioritize accessibility, engagement, and practical learning.

## **Events**

Each chapter must organize at least one major event annually.

Events may include:

- Health awareness campaigns
- Community outreach initiatives
- Educational fairs
- Panel discussions
- Speaker events
- Collaborative programs with partner organizations

Programming should align with HealthDecoded's mission and contribute positively to participant learning experiences.

## **National Check-Ins**

Chapter leadership must participate in at least one meeting each quarter (every 3 months) with HealthDecoded National Leadership or the Chief Operating Officer.

These meetings provide opportunities for guidance, support, collaboration, and organizational updates.

# **Quarterly Reporting Requirements**

Quarterly reporting helps HealthDecoded evaluate chapter growth, impact, and organizational effectiveness.



Reports provide valuable information that supports strategic planning, resource allocation, and recognition efforts.

Each chapter is responsible for submitting reports according to schedules established by the Chief Operating Officer.

Reports should include:

### **Membership Information**

- Total membership
- Number of active members
- Leadership roster updates

### **Events and Programming**

- Activities planned
- Activities completed
- Workshop summaries
- Community outreach efforts

### **Community Impact**

- Number of attendees
- Number of individuals reached
- Educational outcomes when available

### **Financial Information**

- Funds raised
- Expenses incurred
- Budget updates

### **Social Media Performance**

- Follower growth
- Number of posts
- Engagement metrics
- Audience reach

### **Narrative Summary**

Each report should include a brief written summary describing:

- Major accomplishments

- Challenges encountered
- Lessons learned
- Future goals

Quarterly reporting allows chapters to document their impact while helping the national organization better support chapter development.

## **Professionalism, Conduct, and Ethics**

Professionalism is essential to maintaining a positive and effective organizational culture.

Because HealthDecoded members often interact with students, educators, community organizations, healthcare professionals, and the public, members are expected to conduct themselves responsibly and respectfully at all times.

### **Respect and Inclusion**

HealthDecoded is committed to creating welcoming and inclusive environments.

Members should treat all individuals with dignity, respect, and professionalism regardless of background, identity, beliefs, or level of health knowledge.

### **Integrity and Accountability**

Members should act honestly and responsibly in all organizational activities.

Accountability involves accepting responsibility for commitments, communicating openly, and acting in accordance with organizational values.

### **Commitment to Excellence**

Members should strive to contribute positively to chapter activities and represent HealthDecoded professionally.

This includes preparation, reliability, and a willingness to support fellow members.

### **Collaboration and Teamwork**

HealthDecoded chapters function most effectively when members work together toward shared goals.

Members should support one another, share ideas respectfully, and contribute to a positive organizational environment.

### **Reporting Concerns**

Concerns regarding misconduct, harassment, discrimination, financial misconduct, or other violations should be reported to chapter leadership or the Chief Operating Officer.

Reports will be reviewed fairly and appropriately.

Violations may result in corrective action, suspension, removal from leadership positions, loss of membership, or other disciplinary measures when necessary.

## **Chapter Probation, Suspension, and Dissolution**

The goal of HealthDecoded National Leadership is to support chapter success whenever possible. However, situations may arise where intervention becomes necessary.

### **Probation**

A chapter may be placed on probation if it:

- Fails to submit required reports.
- Becomes inactive.
- Fails to maintain leadership positions.
- Does not meet minimum programming requirements.
- Violates organizational policies.

Probation serves as an opportunity for improvement and support.

### **Suspension**

A chapter may be suspended if significant concerns remain unresolved after probation.

Suspended chapters may temporarily lose recognition privileges until corrective actions are completed.

### **Dissolution**

In severe circumstances, chapter recognition may be revoked.

Examples include:

- Fraudulent activity
- Misuse of funds
- Serious misconduct
- Repeated violations of organizational policies
- Extended inactivity

Upon dissolution, the chapter must immediately discontinue use of HealthDecoded branding and organizational affiliation.

## **Frequently Asked Questions**

### **Do I need healthcare experience to join?**

No. Health Decoded welcomes students from all backgrounds and academic interests.

### **How many meetings must chapters hold?**

Chapters must hold at least one meeting each month.

### **How many workshops are required?**

Each chapter must conduct at least two educational workshops annually.

### **Are fundraisers required?**

Yes. Each chapter must organize at least three fundraisers annually.

### **Can chapters create additional leadership positions?**

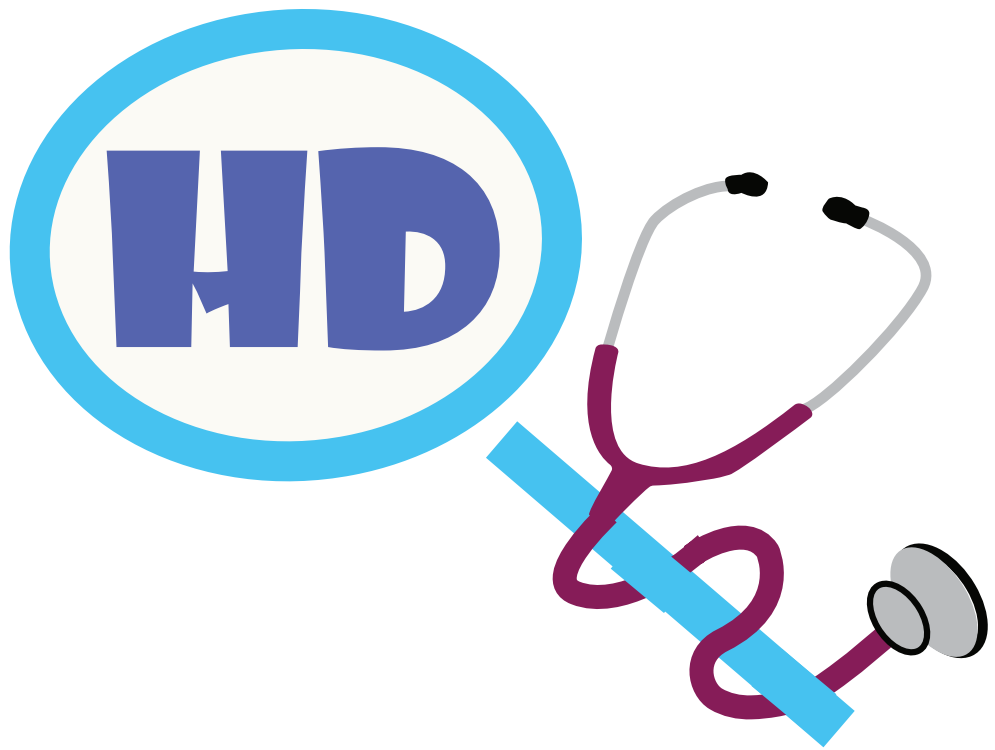
Yes. Chapters may establish additional positions based on their needs and growth.

### **Can membership be revoked?**

Yes. Membership may be revoked for serious misconduct, repeated policy violations, or failure to comply with organizational expectations.

### **Who should chapters contact with questions?**

Questions should be directed to HealthDecoded National Leadership or the Chief Operating Officer.



# **Section 2: Ambassador Information/Requirements**

## **Understanding HealthDecoded Ambassadors**

HealthDecoded Ambassadors serve as student representatives who help promote HealthDecoded's mission through peer education, outreach, and student engagement. While HealthDecoded chapters operate as formal school-based organizations, ambassadors support the organization by helping teach health literacy topics, share resources, promote initiatives, and connect students with opportunities to get involved.

The Ambassador Program was created to give students a flexible but meaningful way to contribute to HealthDecoded's mission. Ambassadors help make health education more accessible by communicating important health-related topics in a way that is clear, practical, and student-friendly.

Ambassadors may support HealthDecoded through presentations, workshops, digital content, peer discussions, awareness campaigns, recruitment, and community outreach. Although ambassadors may not always lead formal chapters, they still play an important role in representing HealthDecoded and expanding the organization's impact.

Being a HealthDecoded Ambassador involves more than simply promoting the organization. Ambassadors are expected to act as student educators, peer leaders, and positive representatives of HealthDecoded.

Through the program, ambassadors develop skills in communication, teaching, public speaking, event planning, research, writing, outreach, and leadership while helping other students better understand important health-related topics.

## **Ambassador Eligibility**

The HealthDecoded Ambassador Program is open to high school students and older students who are interested in supporting HealthDecoded's mission.

Current 8th graders may apply if they are preparing to enter high school and are able to commit to the expectations of the program.

No prior healthcare experience is required. Students from all backgrounds are encouraged to apply, especially those interested in health education, medicine, public health, advocacy, teaching, communication, service, or community engagement.

To be eligible, applicants must:

Submit a completed Ambassador application.

Participate in an interview with HealthDecoded leadership if requested.

Demonstrate interest in HealthDecoded's mission and values.

Commit to serving for one full school year.

Communicate reliably with HealthDecoded leadership.

Represent HealthDecoded professionally and respectfully.

## **Ambassador Role and Purpose**

Ambassadors help increase awareness of HealthDecoded and support educational outreach in their schools, communities, and peer networks. Their role focuses on teaching, representation, outreach, and engagement rather than formal chapter management.

## **Ambassadors may help:**

- Share HealthDecoded resources with peers.
- Promote HealthDecoded events, programs, and initiatives.
- Encourage students to apply for chapter, volunteer, or ambassador opportunities.
- Support awareness campaigns and educational outreach.
- Represent HealthDecoded at school or community events when appropriate.
- Help connect interested students with HealthDecoded leadership.
- Contribute ideas for future programming, outreach, and student engagement.
- Support HealthDecoded's social media and digital outreach efforts.
- Assist with workshops, presentations, and educational campaigns.

Ambassadors should act as positive representatives of the organization and help make HealthDecoded feel accessible, welcoming, and student-centered.

## **Ambassador Commitment**

Ambassadors are expected to commit to the program for one full school year. This commitment helps create consistency, accountability, and long-term engagement within the program.

At the end of the school year, ambassadors may choose to renew their position, apply for a different role, start a chapter, join chapter leadership, or continue supporting HealthDecoded in another capacity.

Ambassadors are expected to remain active throughout the school year by participating in outreach efforts, communicating with HealthDecoded leadership, attending required check-ins when possible, and supporting assigned initiatives.

## **Ambassador Cohorts and Skill-Based Roles**

HealthDecoded Ambassadors may be placed into different cohorts or focus areas based on their skills, interests, and strengths. These cohorts help HealthDecoded organize ambassadors more effectively and allow students to contribute in ways that match their abilities.

Although ambassadors may specialize in different areas, all ambassadors are expected to support HealthDecoded's educational mission. Every cohort should contribute to teaching, peer education, outreach, or the creation of student-friendly health literacy materials.

Ambassadors may indicate skills in one or more of the following areas:



### Public Speaking Cohort

Ambassadors with strong public speaking skills may help lead presentations, speak at workshops, introduce HealthDecoded at school or community events, participate in panels, and represent the organization during outreach opportunities.

Responsibilities may include:

- Presenting health literacy topics to students.
- Speaking at workshops or awareness events.
- Introducing HealthDecoded's mission to new audiences.
- Participating in panels or school presentations.
- Helping train other ambassadors in communication and presentation skills.

Public Speaking Ambassadors should be comfortable communicating clearly, confidently, and professionally with students, educators, and community members.

### Teaching / Tutoring Cohort

Ambassadors with teaching or tutoring experience may help explain health literacy topics to students in a clear and engaging way. This cohort focuses strongly on peer education and making complex topics easier to understand.

Responsibilities may include:

- Leading small-group discussions.
- Helping facilitate workshops.
- Creating interactive learning activities.
- Answering general educational questions.
- Supporting peer-to-peer teaching initiatives.
- Helping adapt health topics for younger or broader audiences.

Teaching / Tutoring Ambassadors should be patient, clear, engaging, and able to explain information in student-friendly language.

### Event Planning / Coordination Cohort

Ambassadors with event planning or coordination skills may help organize workshops, awareness campaigns, community events, panels, fundraisers, and outreach initiatives.

Responsibilities may include:

- Helping plan event timelines.
- Coordinating volunteers and ambassador roles.
- Preparing event materials.
- Communicating with team members.
- Supporting event setup, logistics, and follow-up.
- Helping chapters or HealthDecoded leadership organize larger initiatives.

Event Planning Ambassadors should be organized, reliable, and able to manage tasks effectively.

### Social Media Management / Content Creation Cohort

Ambassadors with social media or content creation skills may help promote HealthDecoded's mission through digital outreach. This cohort helps make health literacy more accessible to students online.

Responsibilities may include:

- Creating educational posts, graphics, or short-form videos.
- Writing captions and campaign materials.
- Promoting events and applications.
- Helping design awareness campaigns.
- Sharing HealthDecoded resources online.
- Supporting Instagram, Linktree, website, or other digital engagement efforts when approved.

Social Media Ambassadors should create content that is accurate, respectful, accessible, and aligned with HealthDecoded's mission and branding.

### Research / Data Analysis Cohort (WILL LAUNCH WHEN REQUIRED UPCOMING SCHOOL YEAR)

Ambassadors with research or data analysis skills may help gather credible information, summarize reliable sources, support content development, evaluate program impact, and analyze outreach data.

Responsibilities may include:

- Researching health literacy topics from credible sources.
- Summarizing educational information for workshops or resources.
- Helping create surveys or feedback forms.
- Reviewing program impact data.
- Supporting evidence-based educational content.
- Helping ensure that HealthDecoded materials are accurate and reliable.

Research Ambassadors should use credible sources and avoid unsupported claims, misinformation, or personal medical recommendations.

### Writing / Editing Cohort

Ambassadors with writing or editing skills may help draft and revise HealthDecoded materials. This cohort helps ensure that educational and promotional content is clear, professional, and easy to understand.

Responsibilities may include:

- Writing educational materials.
- Editing workshop outlines or scripts.
- Drafting newsletters, captions, emails, blog posts, or resource guides.
- Simplifying complex health topics for student audiences.
- Reviewing materials for clarity, tone, and professionalism.
- Supporting outreach documents and campaign language.

Writing / Editing Ambassadors should prioritize accuracy, clarity, accessibility, and professionalism.

### **Teaching Responsibilities Across All Cohorts**

Although ambassadors may specialize in different areas, every cohort should support HealthDecoded's teaching mission. Ambassadors are not simply promoters of the organization; they are student educators who help communicate health literacy topics in ways that are understandable, engaging, and useful for their peers.

Teaching does not always mean standing in front of a classroom. Ambassadors may teach through presentations, peer discussions, educational campaigns, social media content, workshop activities, research summaries, resource guides, or community outreach.

All ambassadors must remember that HealthDecoded provides health literacy education only. Ambassadors may share general educational information and approved resources, but they may not provide medical advice, diagnose conditions, recommend treatment, or answer personal medical questions. If a student asks for personal medical guidance, ambassadors should direct them to a licensed healthcare professional, school health office, emergency services, or another appropriate resource.

### **Cohort Placement**

Ambassadors may be placed into cohorts based on their application responses, interview, skills, interests, availability, and organizational needs. Some ambassadors may belong to more than one cohort if their skills overlap.

Cohort placement is meant to help ambassadors contribute effectively, but it does not limit their involvement. Ambassadors are encouraged to explore different areas, collaborate across cohorts, and develop new skills throughout the school year.

HealthDecoded leadership may adjust cohort assignments as needed based on ambassador performance, availability, program needs, and student interest.

### **Collaboration Between Cohorts**

Ambassador cohorts should work together to support HealthDecoded initiatives. For example, a workshop may require Research Ambassadors to gather accurate information, Writing Ambassadors to create lesson materials, Public Speaking Ambassadors to present, Teaching Ambassadors to facilitate activities, Event Planning Ambassadors to coordinate logistics, and Social Media Ambassadors to promote the event.

This collaborative model allows ambassadors to contribute to larger projects while developing leadership, communication, teamwork, and teaching skills.

By organizing ambassadors into skill-based cohorts, HealthDecoded can provide more meaningful opportunities for student involvement while ensuring that ambassadors actively contribute to the organization's mission of building health literacy through student leadership.

### **Relationship Between Ambassadors and Chapters**

Ambassadors are different from chapter leaders and chapter members. A HealthDecoded chapter is a formal school-based group that organizes meetings, workshops, events, fundraisers, and local

programming. Ambassadors, on the other hand, serve as individual representatives who help promote HealthDecoded, teach health literacy concepts, and support outreach efforts.

If an ambassador's school or community has an existing HealthDecoded chapter, the ambassador may choose to support that chapter's events and initiatives. If no chapter exists nearby, ambassadors may help spread awareness and encourage students to start one.

Students who are interested in creating a stronger HealthDecoded presence in their school are encouraged to consider starting a chapter. Once a chapter exists, members of that chapter may also participate in ambassador or volunteer opportunities when appropriate.

### **Required Forms and Agreements for Ambassadors**

To keep the Ambassador Program organized, professional, and aligned with HealthDecoded's mission, all ambassadors should complete the required forms before officially beginning their role. These forms help HealthDecoded maintain accurate records, set clear expectations, and ensure that all ambassadors understand their responsibilities as representatives of the organization.

Required forms may include:

#### **1. Ambassador Application Form**

This form collects basic information, including name, school, grade/year, email, phone number, location, areas of interest, previous experience, and reasons for wanting to become a HealthDecoded Ambassador.

The application may also ask students to indicate the skills they possess, including:

Public speaking  
Teaching / Tutoring  
Event planning / Coordination  
Social media management / Content creation  
Research / Data analysis  
Writing / Editing

These responses help HealthDecoded place ambassadors into appropriate cohorts and assign opportunities that match their strengths.

#### **2. Ambassador Agreement and Code of Conduct**

Ambassadors must agree to represent HealthDecoded respectfully and professionally. They are expected to communicate responsibly, act with integrity, and uphold the organization's values in all outreach efforts.

Ambassadors must also agree not to misrepresent HealthDecoded, make unauthorized commitments on behalf of the organization, use the organization's name inappropriately, or present themselves as medical professionals.

### 3. Health Information Disclaimer Agreement

Because ambassadors may help teach and share health-related information, they must understand that HealthDecoded provides health literacy education only and does not provide medical diagnosis, treatment, or individualized medical advice.

Ambassadors should only share approved or credible information and should direct personal medical questions to licensed healthcare professionals, school health offices, emergency services, or another appropriate resource.

### 4. Media Release Form

Ambassadors should complete a media release form indicating whether they consent to being photographed, filmed, or featured in HealthDecoded materials, including social media posts, flyers, newsletters, the website, presentations, or promotional content.

Ambassadors should be able to opt out of media use if they prefer.

### 5. Ambassador Commitment Form

Ambassadors should complete a commitment form confirming that they understand the one-school-year commitment and agree to remain actively involved throughout the year.

This form should include expectations for communication, participation, professionalism, cohort involvement, and completion of assigned responsibilities.

### 6. Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver

For larger events, off-campus activities, community outreach, fundraisers, panels, or volunteer opportunities, ambassadors may also be required to complete an event participation or volunteer waiver.

This form should include the event name, date, role expectations, emergency contact information, and acknowledgment of any basic responsibilities or risks connected to the event.

### Summary of Recommended Ambassador Forms

At minimum, every ambassador should complete:

1. Ambassador Application Form
2. Ambassador Agreement and Code of Conduct
3. Health Information Disclaimer Agreement
4. Media Release Form
5. Ambassador Commitment Form

For larger or off-campus events, ambassadors may also complete:

### Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver

These forms help protect the organization, keep communication organized, and ensure that every ambassador understands the mission, expectations, and responsibilities of HealthDecoded.

### **Ambassador Point System and Recognition**

To encourage participation and recognize ambassador contributions, HealthDecoded may establish a point system at the beginning of each academic year.

The point system provides a structured way to track engagement while encouraging ambassadors to participate in outreach, teaching, content creation, recruitment, and organizational initiatives.

Point requirements should be clearly communicated to ambassadors at the beginning of the year. HealthDecoded leadership may adjust point values based on program needs and ambassador responsibilities.

*Suggested point values include:*

### Ambassador Check-In Attendance

Ambassador check-ins provide opportunities for updates, training, planning, and communication with HealthDecoded leadership.

Recommended Value:

2 points per check-in attended

### Educational Workshop Participation

Ambassadors may support workshops by helping present, facilitate activities, prepare materials, promote the event, or assist with follow-up.

Recommended Value:

5 points per workshop supported

### Teaching or Presentation Role

Ambassadors who actively teach, present, lead a discussion, or explain health literacy topics during an event or workshop may receive additional points.

Recommended Value:

5–10 points per teaching or presentation role

### Content Creation

Ambassadors may create educational posts, graphics, videos, captions, newsletters, resource guides, or outreach materials.

Recommended Value:

3–5 points per approved content contribution

### Research or Writing Contribution

Ambassadors may contribute by researching credible sources, drafting materials, editing educational resources, creating workshop outlines, or supporting resource development.

Recommended Value:

3–5 points per approved contribution

### Event Planning or Coordination

Ambassadors may help coordinate event logistics, organize materials, communicate with team members, or support planning.



Recommended Value:  
5–10 points per event supported

### Recruitment and Outreach

Ambassadors may help recruit students for chapters, volunteer roles, ambassador positions, events, or HealthDecoded initiatives.

Recommended Value:  
2 or more points based on level of involvement

### Volunteer Service

Ambassadors may support HealthDecoded's larger events and initiatives, including community events, awareness campaigns, panel discussions, and the summer 5K.

Recommended Value:  
5 points per volunteer activity

### Leadership or Special Projects

Ambassadors who take on additional responsibilities, lead cohort projects, support national initiatives, or complete major assignments may receive additional recognition.

Recommended Value:  
5–15 points depending on project scope

At the beginning of each academic year, HealthDecoded may establish a minimum point requirement for active ambassador status. Ambassadors who exceed expectations may be recognized for outstanding participation, leadership, teaching, outreach, creativity, or impact.

Recognition may include certificates, public recognition, leadership opportunities, recommendation support when appropriate, or eligibility for advanced roles within HealthDecoded.

### **Ambassador Communication and Check-Ins**

Ambassadors are expected to maintain regular communication with HealthDecoded leadership. Communication may take place through email, group messaging platforms, virtual meetings, or other approved channels.

Ambassadors may be asked to participate in periodic check-ins throughout the school year. These check-ins help HealthDecoded provide updates, share upcoming opportunities, answer questions, and support ambassadors in their outreach efforts.

Ambassadors should notify HealthDecoded leadership if they are unable to continue in the role, need support, or have concerns about their responsibilities.

Reliable communication is an important part of ambassador participation. Ambassadors who repeatedly fail to communicate may be considered inactive.

### **Professionalism, Conduct, and Ethics**

Ambassadors are expected to conduct themselves with professionalism, respect, and accountability at all times.

Because ambassadors represent HealthDecoded publicly, they should be mindful of how they communicate with peers, educators, community members, and online audiences. Ambassadors should avoid sharing offensive, discriminatory, inappropriate, or misleading content while representing the organization.

#### **Ambassadors should NOT:**

- Provide medical advice.
- Share medical misinformation.
- Speak on behalf of HealthDecoded without approval.
- Make unauthorized partnerships or commitments.
- Use the HealthDecoded name for personal gain.
- Post inappropriate or unapproved content using the HealthDecoded name.
- Misrepresent their role, title, or authority within the organization.
- Use HealthDecoded materials without proper permission or approval.

Ambassadors are expected to support an inclusive and welcoming environment where students feel comfortable learning about health literacy and getting involved.

### **Social Media and Public Communications**

Social media provides ambassadors with an opportunity to support HealthDecoded's mission through education, outreach, and recruitment.

Ambassadors may share approved HealthDecoded posts, promote events, encourage students to apply for opportunities, and help spread awareness of health literacy topics.

Ambassadors who create content on behalf of HealthDecoded should ensure that all materials are accurate, respectful, professional, and aligned with the organization's mission. Health-related content should be based on credible sources and reviewed when necessary.

Ambassadors should not create independent accounts using the HealthDecoded name, logo, or branding without approval from HealthDecoded leadership.

Public communications should reflect HealthDecoded's commitment to professionalism, accessibility, inclusion, and evidence-based education.

### **Ambassador Renewal and Role Changes**

At the end of each school year, ambassadors may have the opportunity to renew their position for another year. Renewal may depend on participation, communication, professionalism, and continued interest in the organization.

Ambassadors may also choose to apply for a different HealthDecoded role, such as chapter leadership, volunteer leadership, cohort leadership, or another position offered by the organization.

Students who want to create a more formal HealthDecoded presence at their school may be encouraged to start a chapter.

### **Removal from the Ambassador Program**

HealthDecoded reserves the right to remove ambassadors from the program if they fail to meet expectations or violate organizational policies.

Reasons for removal may include:

- Repeated failure to communicate.
- Misrepresentation of HealthDecoded.
- Sharing misinformation.
- Providing medical advice.
- Inappropriate conduct.
- Harassment, discrimination, or disrespectful behavior.
- Failure to follow HealthDecoded guidelines.

- Unauthorized use of the HealthDecoded name, logo, or materials.
- Failure to complete required forms.
- Failure to meet minimum participation requirements.

Removal decisions will be reviewed by HealthDecoded leadership and handled appropriately based on the situation.

## **Summary of Ambassador Expectations**

At minimum, ambassadors are expected to:

- Represent HealthDecoded professionally.
- Promote health literacy among peers.
- Teach or support education in an accessible and student-friendly way.
- Share approved HealthDecoded resources and opportunities.
- Communicate reliably with HealthDecoded leadership.
- Participate in assigned cohort responsibilities.
- Avoid giving medical advice or making unsupported health claims.
- Support outreach, awareness, recruitment, and educational efforts.
- Commit to one full school year of involvement.
- Uphold HealthDecoded's mission, values, and standards.

The Ambassador Program allows students to help expand HealthDecoded's impact even if they are not leading a full chapter. Through teaching, outreach, peer education, and representation, ambassadors help make health literacy more accessible to students across different schools and communities.

## **Frequently Asked Questions**

Do I need healthcare experience to become an ambassador?

No. HealthDecoded welcomes ambassadors from all backgrounds. Interest in health literacy, education, service, leadership, or outreach is more important than prior healthcare experience.

How long is the ambassador's commitment?

Ambassadors are expected to commit for one full school year.

Can current 8th graders apply?

Yes. Current 8th graders may apply if they are preparing to enter high school and can meet the expectations of the program.

Are ambassadors the same as chapter members?

No. Chapters are formal school-based groups, while ambassadors are individual student representatives who support outreach, teaching, and promotion. However, ambassadors may also be involved in a chapter if one exists nearby.

Can ambassadors start a chapter?

Yes. Ambassadors who want to build a stronger HealthDecoded presence at their school are encouraged to start a chapter.

Can ambassadors be in more than one cohort?

Yes. Ambassadors may be placed in more than one cohort if their skills and interests overlap.

Do ambassadors have to teach?

Yes, ambassadors should support HealthDecoded's teaching mission in some form. Teaching may include presentations, peer discussions, educational content, workshop activities, social media posts, research summaries, or resource guides.

Can ambassadors create social media content?

Yes, ambassadors may help create approved content. All content should be accurate, professional, respectful, and aligned with HealthDecoded's mission.

Can ambassadors give medical advice?

No. Ambassadors may share general health literacy education and approved resources, but they may not diagnose conditions, recommend treatments, or provide individualized medical advice.

Who should ambassadors contact with questions?

Questions should be directed to HealthDecoded National Leadership or the appropriate Ambassador Program Coordinator.



# **Section 3: Volunteer Information/Requirements**

# Introduction to Volunteering at HealthDecoded

HealthDecoded volunteers play an important role in supporting health literacy initiatives, educational programming, and community engagement efforts. This section explains expectations, procedures, examples, and best practices related to the topic. Volunteers are encouraged to approach every opportunity with professionalism, reliability, and a commitment to helping students better understand healthcare systems and health-related decision making. HealthDecoded volunteers play an important role in supporting health literacy initiatives, educational programming, and community engagement efforts. This section explains expectations, procedures, examples, and best practices related to the topic. Volunteers are encouraged to approach every opportunity with professionalism, reliability, and a commitment to helping students better understand healthcare systems and health-related decision making.

HealthDecoded volunteers play an important role in supporting health literacy initiatives, educational programming, and community engagement efforts. This section explains expectations, procedures, examples, and best practices related to the topic. Volunteers are encouraged to approach every opportunity with professionalism, reliability, and a commitment to helping students better understand healthcare systems and health-related decision making.

Key considerations include:

- Preparation before events
- Professional conduct during activities
- Respectful communication with participants
- Following guidance from HealthDecoded leadership
- Supporting inclusive learning environments
- Promoting accurate and accessible health information

## Volunteer Roles

HealthDecoded volunteers serve as the organization's front-line support team during educational events, workshops, and community outreach activities. While event planning, partnership development, curriculum design, and organizational operations are managed by the Executive Board, volunteers play an essential role in helping events run smoothly and creating a positive experience for participants. Most volunteer opportunities involve supporting presentations and

workshops conducted at schools, youth programs, community organizations, and other educational settings. Volunteers may assist with event setup, welcoming participants, distributing materials, managing attendance, facilitating small-group discussions, and helping presenters with logistical needs throughout an event. Their presence allows presentations to remain organized, interactive, and engaging for students. During workshops, volunteers are encouraged to actively support participant engagement. This may include helping students follow activities, answering general questions about instructions, encouraging participation during discussions, and ensuring that all participants feel included. Volunteers are not expected to teach curriculum independently or provide healthcare expertise. Instead, they serve as facilitators who help create a supportive learning environment. In addition to workshop support, volunteers may occasionally assist with community outreach events such as health fairs, awareness campaigns, or educational programs hosted by partner organizations. These opportunities allow volunteers to represent HealthDecoded's mission while helping increase awareness of health literacy within the community. Volunteers are not responsible for securing partnerships, coordinating school relationships, developing curriculum, or managing organizational operations. These responsibilities are handled by the Executive Board. However, volunteers contribute significantly to the success of every event by helping ensure that educational programs are organized, welcoming, and effective for participants. Ultimately, volunteers serve as ambassadors of HealthDecoded's mission. Through professionalism, reliability, and positive engagement with students, volunteers help make health education more accessible and impactful while gaining valuable experience in teamwork, communication, and community service.

## **Community Outreach**

A major component of HealthDecoded's mission is bringing health literacy education directly into communities. While the Executive Board is responsible for establishing partnerships and coordinating events, volunteers play an important role in supporting the educational programs that result from these collaborations. Through HealthDecoded, volunteers may have opportunities to participate in events hosted at schools, libraries, community centers, summer programs, health fairs, and other community-based organizations.

Schools represent one of HealthDecoded's primary outreach settings. Educational presentations



and workshops allow students to learn about healthcare navigation, preventive care, medication literacy, digital health literacy, and health equity in an engaging and accessible format. Volunteers may assist with workshop activities, participant engagement, attendance management, and event logistics while helping create a positive learning environment for students.

Libraries and community centers often serve as gathering spaces for educational programs and public events. These settings provide opportunities to reach individuals from diverse backgrounds and age groups. Volunteers participating in these events help support presentations, distribute educational materials, and encourage meaningful discussions about health-related topics.

HealthDecoded may also partner with summer programs and youth organizations to deliver educational programming outside of traditional classroom settings. These events often allow for interactive activities, group discussions, and hands-on learning experiences. Volunteers help ensure these programs remain organized, engaging, and welcoming for participants.

Community health fairs and awareness events provide another valuable opportunity for involvement. These events often bring together healthcare organizations, educational groups, and community members in a shared effort to promote health awareness. Volunteers may assist with informational booths, educational activities, participant engagement, and resource distribution.

Participation in these outreach opportunities allows volunteers to gain experience working with diverse populations while contributing to meaningful educational initiatives. Volunteers also develop valuable communication, teamwork, and community engagement skills that can be applied in future academic, professional, and service experiences. Every outreach event represents an opportunity to help make health information more accessible and empower individuals to make informed decisions about their health and well-being.

## **Professionalism and Communication**

Professionalism is one of the most important expectations for all HealthDecoded volunteers. Because volunteers represent the organization during educational events and community programs, their conduct directly influences how participants, educators, parents, and community partners perceive HealthDecoded. Professionalism involves reliability, respect, accountability,

and a commitment to supporting the organization's mission.

Communication is a key component of professionalism. Volunteers are expected to monitor organizational communication channels regularly and respond to messages within a reasonable timeframe whenever possible. Timely communication helps event coordinators plan effectively and ensures that responsibilities can be assigned appropriately. If a volunteer is unable to attend an event after committing to participate, leadership should be notified as soon as possible so alternative arrangements can be made.

Email communication should remain professional and respectful. Messages should be clear, concise, and appropriate for communication with educators, community partners, and fellow volunteers. When corresponding through email, volunteers should avoid informal language that may be perceived as unprofessional and should review messages before sending them.

Many organizational updates may also be shared through group chats or messaging platforms. While these platforms may feel more informal, volunteers should continue to communicate respectfully and professionally. Group chats should remain focused on organizational activities, event coordination, and volunteer responsibilities. Maintaining a positive and constructive communication environment helps ensure that all members feel respected and supported.

Reliability is another essential aspect of professionalism. When volunteers commit to participating in an event, they should make every effort to fulfill that commitment. Consistent attendance, punctuality, and preparedness contribute significantly to the success of workshops and presentations. Even small responsibilities can have a meaningful impact on the overall participant experience.

Ultimately, professionalism is demonstrated through everyday actions. Respectful communication, dependable participation, and a positive attitude help create an environment where volunteers, participants, and community partners can work together effectively. By maintaining high standards of professionalism, volunteers help strengthen HealthDecoded's reputation and support the continued growth of its educational initiatives.

## **Boundaries and Ethics**

HealthDecoded is an educational organization dedicated to improving health literacy. As a result, volunteers must understand and respect the boundaries associated with their role. While volunteers may help explain general health concepts and support educational activities, they are not healthcare providers and should never present themselves as medical professionals.

One of the most important ethical responsibilities is avoiding the provision of medical advice. Volunteers should not diagnose medical conditions, recommend treatments, interpret medical test results, suggest medications, or advise participants regarding specific healthcare decisions. If a participant asks a question that requires professional medical expertise, volunteers should politely explain that they are unable to provide medical advice and encourage the individual to consult a qualified healthcare professional.

Respect for privacy and confidentiality is equally important. During workshops and community events, participants may occasionally share personal experiences or health-related concerns. Volunteers should treat this information respectfully and avoid discussing personal details outside of the event setting. Creating an environment where participants feel comfortable engaging in educational discussions requires trust and discretion.

Volunteers are also expected to treat all participants with dignity and respect regardless of age, background, identity, beliefs, or level of health knowledge. HealthDecoded is committed to creating inclusive learning environments where all individuals feel welcomed and valued. Volunteers should contribute to this goal through respectful interactions and professional conduct.

Social media use should also reflect the organization's values. Volunteers should avoid sharing photos, videos, or information from events without appropriate permission and should refrain from posting content that could misrepresent HealthDecoded or compromise participant privacy. When referencing organizational activities online, volunteers should do so responsibly and

professionally.

Occasionally, volunteers may encounter difficult situations, such as disruptive behavior, sensitive questions, or participant concerns that fall outside the scope of a workshop. In these situations, volunteers should remain calm, avoid confrontation, and seek assistance from event leaders or Executive Board members when necessary. Understanding personal limitations and requesting guidance when appropriate is an important part of ethical and responsible volunteer service.

By maintaining clear boundaries, protecting participant privacy, and acting with integrity, volunteers help create safe, respectful, and effective educational experiences for everyone involved.

## **Volunteer Curriculum & Areas of Exploration**

### **Exploring the HealthDecoded Curriculum**

One of the unique aspects of volunteering with HealthDecoded is the opportunity to engage with educational content that addresses real-world healthcare topics often overlooked in traditional classrooms. While volunteers are not expected to be healthcare experts, they are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the subjects covered in HealthDecoded presentations and workshops. Doing so allows volunteers to better support participants during events while also expanding their own understanding of important health-related topics.

A major component of the curriculum focuses on healthcare navigation. Many students are unfamiliar with how the healthcare system functions until they are required to use it independently. HealthDecoded introduces concepts such as primary care providers, specialists, urgent care centers, emergency departments, referrals, and appointment scheduling. Students learn practical skills that can help them confidently access healthcare services and communicate their needs effectively.

Another key topic is preventive care. Rather than viewing healthcare solely as a response to illness, students are encouraged to understand the value of maintaining long-term health through

healthy habits and preventive measures. Discussions may include routine checkups, vaccinations, nutrition, physical activity, sleep, stress management, and wellness practices that contribute to overall health. These lessons emphasize that prevention often plays a critical role in improving health outcomes.

Medication literacy is also an important area of focus. Students are introduced to concepts such as prescription medications, dosage instructions, medication adherence, and safe medication practices. The curriculum helps students understand the importance of following professional medical guidance and encourages responsible approaches to medication use.

In today's digital environment, digital health literacy has become increasingly important. Students are constantly exposed to health information through websites, videos, social media platforms, and online discussions. HealthDecoded helps participants learn how to evaluate sources, recognize misinformation, identify credible information, and make informed decisions when encountering health-related content online. These skills are particularly valuable in an age where inaccurate information can spread rapidly.

Health equity is another significant component of the curriculum. Students explore how factors such as socioeconomic status, geography, education, language barriers, and access to healthcare resources can influence health outcomes. These discussions encourage participants to think critically about healthcare access and the challenges faced by different communities. The goal is not only to increase awareness but also to foster empathy and understanding.

Volunteers are encouraged to view the curriculum as an opportunity for personal growth as well as community service. Exposure to these topics can strengthen communication skills, broaden perspectives on public health issues, and deepen understanding of healthcare systems. Whether a volunteer plans to pursue a healthcare-related career or simply wishes to become a more informed member of their community, the educational content offered through HealthDecoded provides valuable knowledge that extends far beyond individual workshops and presentations.

## **Required Forms and Agreements for Volunteers**

To keep HealthDecoded volunteer involvement organized, professional, and aligned with the organization's mission, all volunteers should complete the required forms before participating in HealthDecoded activities. These forms help HealthDecoded maintain accurate records, clarify expectations, protect participants, and ensure that volunteers understand their responsibilities during educational programs, community outreach events, and larger initiatives.

Required forms help leadership coordinate events more effectively, track volunteer participation, communicate important updates, and make sure all volunteers understand that HealthDecoded is a health literacy education organization rather than a provider of medical care or individualized health guidance.

### **Required for All Volunteers**

All volunteers should complete the following forms before officially participating in HealthDecoded volunteer opportunities:

#### **1. Volunteer Registration Form**

The Volunteer Registration Form collects basic information needed for communication, scheduling, and participation tracking.

This form should include:

- Name
- School or organization affiliation
- Grade/year, if applicable
- Email address
- Phone number
- Location
- Availability
- Areas of interest

- Emergency contact information
- Previous volunteer, leadership, teaching, or outreach experience
- Types of events the volunteer is interested in supporting

This form helps HealthDecoded maintain an organized volunteer roster and match volunteers with appropriate opportunities.

## 2. Volunteer Agreement and Code of Conduct

All volunteers must agree to represent HealthDecoded respectfully and professionally. Volunteers are expected to communicate responsibly, arrive prepared, follow event instructions, support inclusive learning environments, and treat all participants, educators, community members, and fellow volunteers with respect.

Volunteers must understand that they are representing both HealthDecoded and the broader mission of improving student health literacy. Their conduct during events, workshops, online communication, and outreach activities should reflect professionalism, reliability, and accountability.

Volunteers should agree not to:

- Misrepresent HealthDecoded or their role within the organization.
- Make unauthorized commitments on behalf of HealthDecoded.
- Use the HealthDecoded name, logo, or materials without permission.
- Engage in disrespectful, discriminatory, or inappropriate conduct.
- Share confidential or personal information from participants.
- Act outside the responsibilities assigned to them by HealthDecoded leadership.

## 3. Health Information Disclaimer Agreement

Because HealthDecoded works with health-related topics, volunteers must understand that the

organization provides health literacy education only. HealthDecoded does not provide medical diagnosis, treatment, individualized medical advice, or emergency medical services.

Volunteers may help support workshops, distribute educational materials, assist with activities, and encourage participant engagement, but they should not provide personal medical recommendations or present themselves as healthcare professionals.

Volunteers should not:

- Diagnose medical conditions.
- Recommend medications or treatments.
- Interpret medical symptoms, test results, or health concerns.
- Tell participants whether they need a specific type of medical care.
- Answer personal medical questions as if they are medical professionals.

If a participant asks for personal medical guidance, volunteers should politely explain that they cannot provide medical advice and direct the individual to a licensed healthcare professional, school health office, emergency services, or another appropriate resource.

#### 4. Media Release Form

Volunteers should complete a media release form indicating whether they consent to being photographed, filmed, or featured in HealthDecoded materials.

These materials may include:

- Social media posts
- Flyers
- Newsletters
- Website content
- Presentations
- Promotional materials



- Event recaps
- Grant or partnership materials

Volunteers should be able to opt out of media use if they prefer. HealthDecoded should respect each volunteer's media preference and avoid using identifiable images or videos of volunteers who have not granted permission.

## 5. Volunteer Commitment and Participation Agreement

Volunteers should complete a commitment agreement confirming that they understand the expectations of participating in HealthDecoded volunteer opportunities.

This agreement should clarify that volunteers are expected to:

- Participate in at least three HealthDecoded activities per academic year to remain active.
- Communicate in a timely and professional manner.
- Notify leadership as soon as possible if they can no longer attend an event.
- Arrive on time and prepared for events they sign up for.
- Follow instructions from HealthDecoded leadership or event coordinators.
- Support participants respectfully and inclusively.
- Complete assigned responsibilities to the best of their ability.

This form helps ensure that volunteers understand the importance of reliability and follow-through.

## **Event-Specific Forms**

For certain volunteer opportunities, HealthDecoded may require additional forms depending on the nature of the event.

## 6. Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver

For larger events, off-campus activities, community outreach programs, fundraisers, panel discussions, health fairs, summer programs, or the summer 5K, volunteers may be required to complete an Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver.

This form should include:

- Event name
- Event date and location
- Volunteer role or assignment
- Expected time commitment
- Emergency contact information
- Acknowledgment of event responsibilities
- Acknowledgment of any basic risks connected to the activity
- Agreement to follow event safety guidelines and leadership instructions

This form helps HealthDecoded prepare for events and ensures that volunteers understand their role before participating.

## 7. Transportation or Travel Acknowledgment Form

For events requiring volunteers to travel off campus or to community locations, HealthDecoded may use a transportation or travel acknowledgment form.

This form may clarify:

- Whether volunteers are responsible for their own transportation
- Meeting location and arrival time
- Departure and pickup expectations
- Parking or transit information
- Emergency contact procedures
- Expectations for safe and responsible travel

This form is especially useful for community events, school presentations, health fairs, or outreach opportunities hosted outside the volunteer's regular school or campus.

## 8. Confidentiality and Participant Privacy Agreement

Volunteers may occasionally hear personal experiences, sensitive questions, or health-related concerns during workshops and outreach events. Volunteers should complete a confidentiality and participant privacy agreement acknowledging that participant information should be treated respectfully and not discussed outside the event setting.

Volunteers should agree not to share:

- Personal stories shared by participants
- Health-related concerns disclosed during an event
- Identifying information about participants
- Photos or videos without permission
- Private conversations from workshops or outreach activities

This agreement helps maintain trust and supports a safe, respectful learning environment.

## **Summary of Recommended Volunteer Forms**

At minimum, every HealthDecoded volunteer should complete:

- Volunteer Registration Form
- Volunteer Agreement and Code of Conduct
- Health Information Disclaimer Agreement
- Media Release Form
- Volunteer Commitment and Participation Agreement

For larger, off-campus, or community-based events, volunteers may also complete:

- Event Participation or Volunteer Waiver
- Transportation or Travel Acknowledgment Form
- Confidentiality and Participant Privacy Agreement

These forms help protect HealthDecoded, support strong communication, and ensure that volunteers understand their responsibilities before participating in events. By completing the required forms, volunteers help create organized, professional, and safe educational experiences for the students and communities HealthDecoded serves.

## **Frequently Asked Questions**

Do I need prior healthcare experience to volunteer?

No. HealthDecoded welcomes volunteers from all academic backgrounds and experience levels. A willingness to learn, contribute, and support educational programming is far more important than previous healthcare knowledge.

How many activities must I participate in each year?

Volunteers are expected to participate in at least three HealthDecoded activities per academic year to remain active within the organization. These activities may include workshops, presentations, outreach events, or other approved volunteer opportunities.

Will my participation be tracked?

Yes. Volunteer participation is recorded to help recognize contributions, verify involvement when appropriate, and assist with organizational planning. Maintaining accurate records also helps ensure that opportunities are distributed fairly among volunteers.

Can volunteering help me develop professional skills?

Absolutely. Volunteers often strengthen communication, teamwork, public speaking, organization, leadership, and community engagement skills through their involvement. These experiences can be valuable in academic, professional, and service-oriented settings.

Will I be expected to teach presentations?

No. The Executive Board is responsible for organizing events, developing curriculum, and leading presentations. Volunteers primarily assist with workshop operations, participant engagement, logistics, and event support.

What should I do if I cannot attend an event after signing up?

Notify leadership as soon as possible. Early communication helps organizers make necessary adjustments and ensure that events remain adequately staffed.

HealthDecoded exists because of volunteers who are willing to dedicate their time and energy to improving health literacy within their communities. Every workshop supported, every participant welcomed, and every educational opportunity made possible through volunteer service contributes to a larger mission of empowering students with practical health knowledge. Thank you for choosing to be part of that mission and for helping make health education more accessible, engaging, and impactful for future generations.